



DRY DAYS

IN A CRUEL twist of fate, residents of a slum line up an assortment of boxes and cans for water at a public tank in one of Mumbai's richest localities, Malabar Hill, which is home to several industrialists and ministers.

KUTCH-HIMTRA



WITH SECULAR CREDENTIALS ON HIS FAMOUS SLEEVES, BACHCHAN IS ACTING AS GUJARAT TOURISM'S BRAND AMBASSADOR.

AHMEDABAD | Star Envoy

Amitabh Bachchan seems to be Narendra Modi's new blue-eyed boy. Last week, the Bollywood star reiterated his friendship with the chief minister by carrying out his promise of becoming the brand ambassador for Gujarat Tourism. Discarding the state Government's request to arrive in a special plane, Bachchan flew economy class to the sweltering heat of the Rann of Kutch to shoot for a state-sponsored campaign called Khushboo Gujarat Ki. After the Rann, he travelled to Mandvi beach and then Gir Sanctuary. Bachchan said, "If my promotion of tourism in Gujarat can be called social service then I am happy that I will be devoting more 100 hours for Gujarat's cause." This followed Modi's appeal that every Gujarati devote at least 100 hours for a cause in the interest of the state in its golden jubilee year. With Modi embroiled in controversies regarding fake encounters, he is hoping that the Bachchan can become his happy intermission.

by Uday Mahurkar